

Figure 4: Thunderbird is also an RSS feed reader

Apart from email, Thunderbird can also display content from RSS feeds (as shown in Figure 4) and Usenet forums (as shown in Figure 5).

Usenet newsgroups predate the World Wide Web. They are like an online discussion forum organised into several hierarchical groups. Forum participants post messages in the form of an email addressed to a newsgroup (say *comp.lang.javascript*), and the NNTP client threads the discussions based on the subject line (Google Groups is a Web based interface into the world of Usenet).

SeaMonkey ChatZilla

Apart from the Firefox-based browser and the Thunderbird-based email client, SeaMonkey also bundles an IRC chat client. IRC is yet another Internet-based communication protocol that does not use the World Wide Web. It is the preferred medium of communication for hackers. Here is a link for starters: irc://chat.freenode.net/.

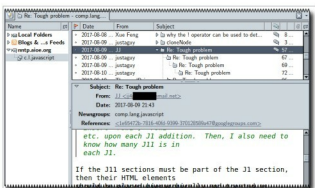


Figure 5: A newsgroup user sends an email message

Email backup

When you store email offline, the burden of doing regular backups falls on you. You also need to ensure that your computer is not vulnerable to malware such as email viruses. Web mail providers do a good job of eliminating email-borne malware, but malware can still arrive from other sources. Windows computers are particularly vulnerable to malware spread by USB drives and browser toolbars and extensions. In Windows, simply creating a directory named 'autorun.inf' at the root level stops most USB drive infections.

SeaMonkey stores all its data (email messages and accounts, RSS feeds, website user names/ passwords/ preferences, etc.) in the `~/mozilla/SeaMonkey` directory. For backup, just zip this directory regularly. If you move to a new GNU/Linux system, restore the backed-up directory to your new `~/mozilla` directory. [END](#)

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